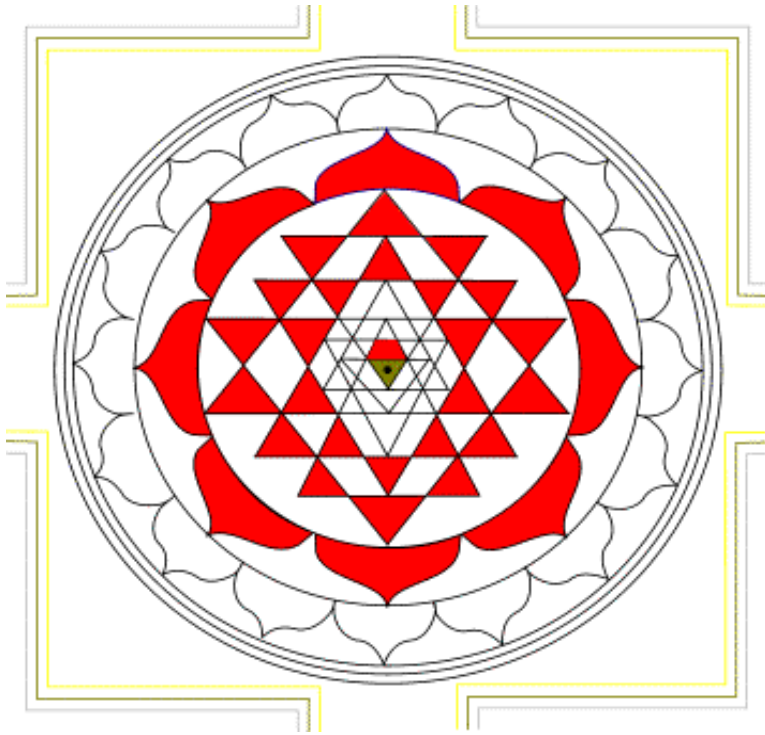




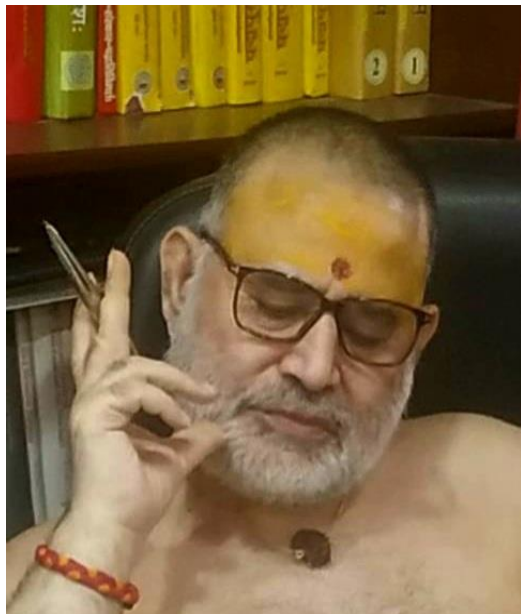
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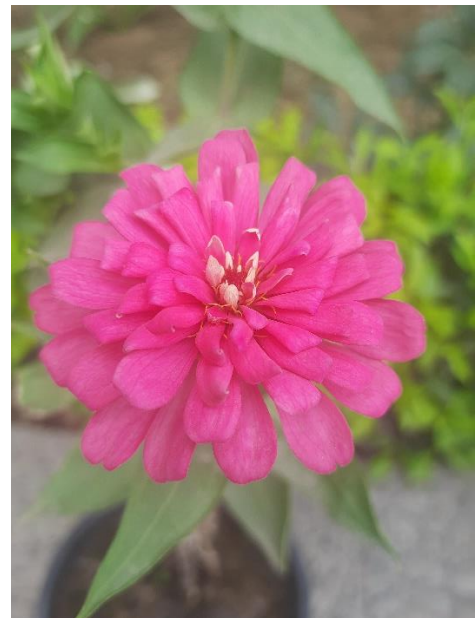
July-September 2023



From the Chief Editor's Desk

Mystery of the Alphanumeric Almanac

Time cycle integrated with word and meaning is a spontaneous stream of consciousness which upon syncing with individual streamline of



consciousness makes spiritual evolution into the stature of absolute shiva, automatic and effortless . There is an analogy of a man on board a ship ,jogging on the deck. His jogging fast or slow has nothing to do with reaching the shore soon or late . Syncing one's awareness with automatic turning

of this esoteric wheel of time, rotating in dimensions of time, word and meaning is the key.

The esoteric concept of thirty- six elements put together as the universal phenomena can be traced back to an eon predating Upavarshachacrya the preceptor of Panini, the first exponent of descriptive linguist of Sanskrit. There are three theories of evolution of the universal phenomena , that of successive generation , the theory of successive generation of categories and the theory of concomitant emergence. All of these are the corollaries of a single lineage which trifurcate to benefit three various offshoots. The first alphabet अ in this arcane cult denotes completeness or all pervasiveness . This vowel pervades all other vowels signifying Shiva and thirty six consonants which stand for the universal phenomena comprising as many tatwas or elementary constituents . This first also denoted the self luminant universal self I.e. Shiva or to be more precise Shiv tatwa.

There is a four tiered rotation of the tatwas or Tatwa chakra , the eons , (युगपरिवृतिः) great rotation according to this arcane timescale the current one is the third eon which reads as खेत्तीयेयुगे (महापरिवृति) which is currently the one nineteenth tatwa or eye (उनविंशे नयनतत्वे) Just rotation(परिवृतिः) ,the last one is a monthly rotation which in this esoteric Almanac has thirty six days each pertaining to one tatwa. On the day of writing this editorial it was फ पाणि I.e. twenty second tatwa.

The equinox of these tatwa alphabet and time fraction is considered very holy and auspicious The divine mystic Wisdom dawns upon an evolved aspirant during this concurrence and for the less competent aspirants worship of the sacred chakra, japa and other practices definitely fructify. There are sixteen months in one year each corresponding to one vowel which stand for the sixteen digits of sadashiva .

Word transcendence ,time and space transcendence including word and meaning

transcendence which are imperative become effortless and spontaneous as one resorts to this arcane discipline -under a competent preceptor's guidance though .In the Agamas the word from the gurus mouth is more authentic than the testimony of evidence of the revelations ,their purport as it were has already been assimilated by the preceptor through a lineage of preceptors before he imparts the essential of the revelations which aim at transcending word and meaning conglomerate . The alphanumeric almanac has been devised by hoary adepts to bypass the discursive and dialectic details of agamic philosophy and to awaken the acolyte in the realm of the guru's experience of subjective epiphany .

सिद्धिदागुरुवगेव सर्वग्रंथा विडंबकाः।

Words only from the guru's mouth leads to completion, all scriptures are delusive . The guru evidently wouldn't impart the secret of word transcendence in one thousand words -hence the esoteric knacks . A time manifestation of the universal mother कालचक्रेश्वरी needs a great deal of intellectual saturation and high order of competence for its adoration . यदातेमोहकलिलं बुद्धिर्वतितरिष्यति

तदागंतासि निर्वेदं श्रोतव्यस्य श्रुतस्य च (गीता)

To transcend all that has been learnt and what ever is yet to be learnt one must cross the swamp of delusive quagmire . This almanac is also a tactic of going beyond the known and unknown .

SwamiParanand Tirth

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Editorial



Acquiring knowledge is usually understood as a progressive phenomena and is supposed to be imparted step by step. This linear development of knowledge which requires tremendous effort, even after a lifetime cannot bring an aspirant to the threshold of the knowledge of self. Rather too much indulgence and pride in the former can mislead one and lead to a bloated sense of ego and its achievements, which unfortunately is quite rampant these days. This delusive knowledge of self has immense power and charm and can keep an individual completely in its sway. To escape such a fate process of 'unlearning' is given a lot of importance in all true spiritual lineages. This unlearning opens up the space for the knowledge of self to dawn on the aspirant. Hence importance is given to realized knowledge which dawns in a flash and which is usually triggered by 'knacks' imparted by a competent master depending on the aspirants capability, sensitivity and sincerity.

Explaining the notion we begin with the insightful editorial by our Guru Maharaj, Swami Paranand Tirth ji on the arcane alphanumeric almanac and its spiritual significance. 'The equinox of the tatwa alphabet and time fraction is considered very holy and auspicious The divine mystic wisdom dawns upon an evolved aspirant during this concurrence and for the less competent aspirants worship of the sacred chakra, japa and other practices definitely fructify.'

Next we have translation and exposition of 6th verse of 'Neel Saraswati Stotram' from 'Brihanneel Tantra'. In this verse is explained how gods were victorious in the war with demons due to Ma Tara's munificence, but because they could not keep their ego in check they were destined to perish.

'Déjà vu and the brain' is the title of the next academic paper by Bhoomi Sati. Clarifying this perplexing concept she writes 'Déjà vu is the term used to express the strange feeling of having done something before although knowing you have never done it. Most experts concur that this phenomenon most likely has some connection to memory. So, if you feel déjà vu, it is possible that you've had a similar experience in the past. Simply put, you can't recall it.

Next we have a short write up on the concept of 'Ananda' by Geetika which talks about the vedantic idea and compares the same with Neo Platonic ideas of Plotinus.

Next we have the translation and exposition on two sutras (17th and 18th) of Pratyabhijna Hridayam by Kshemraj from the YTA study circle and a brief insight into the online classes being conducted by YTA.

Following this we have two soulful poems by Ambika Talwar inspired by photographs clicked by Geetika back in 2020. The poetic exchange of visuals and verbals have been cherished by both. The first poem titled 'Carnelian Tears' gives voice to extreme longing of a lover for the beloved. 'To birth a New Life' is the title of the next poem in which the poetess evocatively gives voice to the feeling of loss and search for new beginnings.



(Kimiya)

NEEL SARASWATI STOTRAM

(A Hymn to the sapphire goddess of wisdom from Brihanneel Tantra) Cont.



Semiotic depictions of metaphysical phenomena .

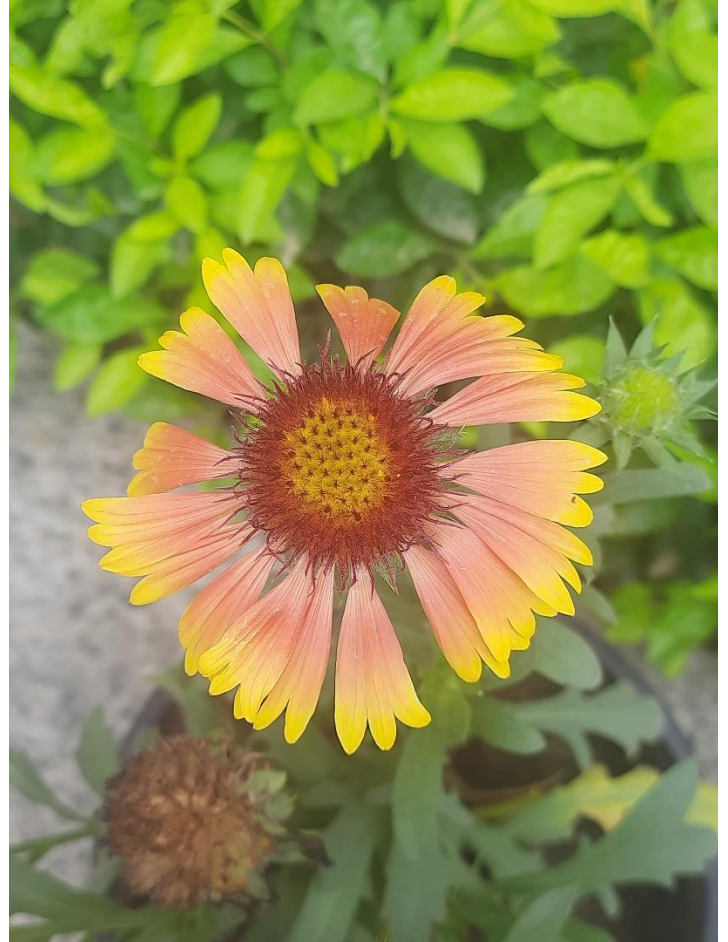
मातस्त्वत्पदपङ्कजद्वयरजोमुद्राङ्गकोटीरिण-
स्ते देवासुरसंगरे विजयिनो निःशङ्कमङ्गे गताः।
देवोऽहं भुवने न मे सम इति स्पृह्यं वहन्तः परे
तत्तुल्या नियतं तथा चिरममी नाशं व्रजन्ति स्वयम्॥ ६॥

Those gods went to war and conquered demons without any fear since their head gears were marked by the pollen grains of thy lotus feet . but they perish because of their malice and avarice towards one another –saying that I am a god and none else is like me in the kingdom of heaven .

In these verses it is explained how by the benevolence of Ma Tara, Gods could fearlessly fight their battles and turn out to be victorious but their bloated egos not only took the credit but also started belittling the other gods. Each

one of them claiming the sole responsibility for the victory developed avarice and hatred for others which ultimately led to their perishing.

Swami Paranand Tirth

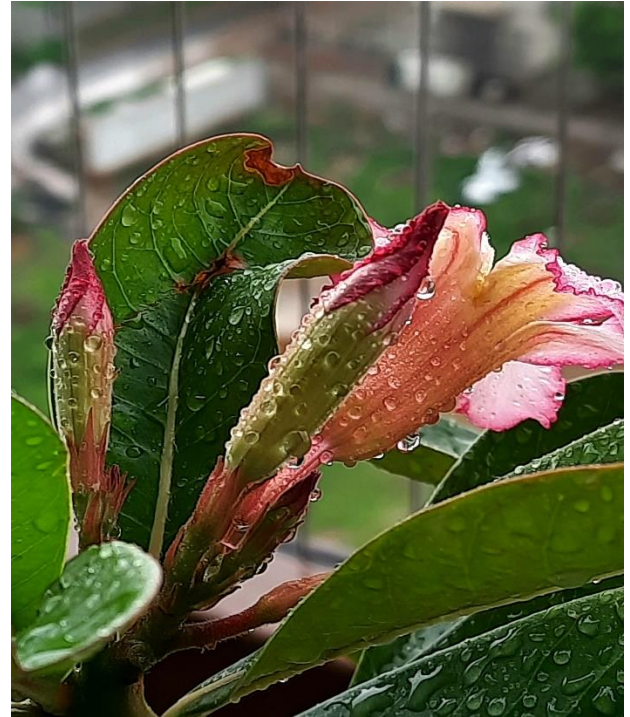




Déjà vu and the brain

Bhoomi Sati

The phrase “déjà vu” describes the sensation of having gone through a current circumstance before. Two out of three people- men and women- experience it at some point in their life which makes it incredibly prevalent. Additionally the frequency of déjà vu reduces with age, yet it still occurs once a year for individuals who experience it. Déjà vu is difficult to examine due to its fleeting nature, therefore it is unclear what triggers it. Some experts explain it by differences or mistakes in the areas of the brain that manage memory. Déjà vu can also be thought as the result of the collision of two different awarenesses: the recognition of a current circumstance and the sense that this memory is unreliable. The realization that this is something they have never genuinely seen before is a crucial component. Even though Cleary's research suggests that even a passing familiarity can cause déjà vu, it's unclear whether actual familiarity is required to cause the sense. Akira



O'Connor, of the University of St. Andrews in the UK asserts that although "those kinds of ideas make a fair amount of sense," "we're actually really good at telling apart very similar things." According to him, it's entirely feasible that the impression of familiarity in cases of spontaneous déjà vu is coincidental. The medial temporal lobe, a part of the brain which is important for memory storage and retrieval, detects familiarity and can occasionally overreact for no apparent reason, according to O'Connor. The fact that young people actually experience more déjà vu than older people lends credence to this random-misfire theory. According to O'Connor, younger brains are a little more excitable and more likely to fire fast than to hold back.

According to Professor Berkovic, researching people who experience epileptic seizures—which happen when there is an aberrant

electrical discharge in portion of the brain—has taught scientists a lot about how the brain functions. When a seizure starts, people who have epilepsy can feel a heightened and intense déjà vu. This is frequently a sign of a discharge in the hippocampus, a portion of the brain that governs memory and is located deep within the temporal lobe and beneath the temples. However, the déjà vu that an epileptic experience lasts longer and is more powerful than what is known as physiological déjà vu, or regular déjà vu in persons who do not have epilepsy.

It can also be associated to a feeling of “sixth sense”. Sixth sense is a term which isn’t exactly scientific but people use it to indicate that there’s something going on in their heads even though they can’t exactly pin point towards what it actually is.

When a student approached Professor Howe, a researcher in this field, with an odd experience she described as a sixth sense, he made the decision to investigate this perplexing feeling further. The student recently reconnected with a classmate she hadn't seen in a while and assumed right once that he had been involved in an automobile accident. It can be challenging to recreate fleeting memories or sensations in a laboratory. However, Professor Howe along with his student, Margaret Webb believed they could duplicate this student's experience by displaying identical images of the same individual. Participants were required to point out what the change was in the images or whether or not there was even a change. Most of the participants claimed to realize that there was a change but weren’t able to determine what the change was.

Therefore, it is possible that the student who had asserted possessing a sixth sense had unwittingly picked up on minute details about her acquaintance that led her to conclude—correctly—that he had been involved in a car accident. Similar studies conducted by

Professor Howe have shown that humans process much more information when they look at something than they realize. Their subjective awareness may have only included one or two facial aspects, but their brain has undoubtedly taken in many more. Someone experiencing déjà vu may be going through a similar process. One may have experienced an unsettling sense of familiarity as a result of anything they saw or heard, but the person is unsure of where the recollection originated. According to Professor Howe, research on déjà vu have attempted to conjure up fake memories in subjects by presenting them with a series of words that are conceptually comparable. This type of déjà vu is brought on by the brain absorbing more information than the person is consciously aware of, just like in Professor Howe's research.

The theory that the brain creates false memories to explain déjà vu has been disproved, according to study by Akira O'Connor and his team. It has long been unclear how déjà vu functions, in part because it is challenging to investigate due to its transitory and unexpected nature. O'Connor and his colleagues came up with a method to induce déjà vu in the lab to circumvent this. To observe what was occurring in the individuals' brains, he used MRI scans. He discovered that the memory conflict or "checking through" our memories-related frontal regions of the brain were activated by the déjà vu experience. He came to the conclusion that déjà vu might be caused by the brain attempting to correct a discrepancy between what you believe you have seen in the past and what you are actually experiencing.

Déjà vu is the term used to express the strange feeling of having done something before although knowing you have never done it. Most experts concur that this phenomenon most likely has some connection to memory. So, if you feel déjà vu, it is possible that you've had a similar experience in the past. Simply put, you can't recall it.

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Ananda Mimamsa

According to Sanskrit grammar the word Ananda is derived by using a prefix Prefix आ before the Root च्द with a suffix घञ (ganya). This means to make happy, please, rejoice. As a noun it means bliss or happiness. The term also pertains to the Brahman or the absolute principle. Taittiriya Upanisad attributes Anandam or Anantam as one of the three formal characteristics (svarupa laksana) of Brahman. The other two being Satyam (Existence) and Chittam (Consciousness). The second chapter of Taittiriya Upanishad, titled Ananda Valli and sometimes called *Brahmananda Valli*, focuses like other ancient Upanishads on the theme of Atman (Self, Soul) and Brahman being one entity and the bliss produced by such a recognition. The Ananda Valli asserts that knowing one's Self is the path to freedom from all concerns, fears and to a positive state of blissful living.

The Ananda Valli is remarkable for its *Kosha* (Sanskrit: कोष) theory (or *Layered Maya* theory), suggesting that a human being reaches his/her highest potential and understands the deepest knowledge by a process of differentiating between right and wrong knowledge. Real deeper knowledge is hidden in layers of superficial knowledge, but since superficial knowledge is easier and simplistic one can get easily swayed by it and completely lose the sight of real knowledge

To explain this Ananda Valli classifies these as concentric layers (sheaths) which surround our true essence. The outermost layer it calls *Annamaya* which envelops and hides *Pranamaya*, which in turn envelops *Manomaya*, inside which is *Vijnanamaya*, and finally the *Anandamaya* which the Upanishad states is the innermost, deepest layer. The ananda-maya is characterized by love, joy, cheerfulness, bliss and Brahman. The individuals who are aware of ananda-maya, assert the sixth to eighth verses of Ananda Valli, are those who simultaneously realize the empirical and the spiritual, the conscious and unconscious, the changing and the eternal, the time and the timeless and hence are perpetually in the state of bliss and unison with the supreme reality. In this blissful state there is no differentiation between subject and the object and hence it entails total identification with Brahman.

The concept predates but is quite similar to Plotinus's Neo Platonic idea of 'One'. The three basic principles of Plotinus' metaphysics are called by him 'the One' (or, equivalently, 'the Good'), Intellect, and Soul. These principles are both ultimate ontological realities and explanatory principles. Plotinus believed that they were recognized by Plato as such, as well as by the entire subsequent Platonic tradition. The One is the absolutely simple first principle of all. It is both 'self-caused' and the cause of being for everything else in the universe. There are, according to Plotinus, various ways of showing the necessity of positing such a principle. The One as a principle Plotinus found it in Plato's *Republic* where it is named 'the Idea of the Good'. The One or the Good, owing to its simplicity, is indescribable directly. We can only grasp it indirectly by deducing what it is not.

Vedantins maintain that the essential nature of Brahman is Anandam since Ananda the absence of dukha comprises foundation of the former

In AdiShankara's commentary on Taittiriya Upanisad notions like Existence, Consciousness and Bliss are merely to refute the contradictory attributes like In-existence, In-Sentience and Misery. These cannot define the attributeless Brahman

In the Vivarna school of Monism 'Prakashatmayati' has propounded that characteristics like Ananda, Sense perceptions, Visavanubhava and Nityatvam or Eternity

are inseparable but virtually appear to be separate and different

आनंदमयोऽभासात् (Aphorism)

Some dualists and Tantrik Shakta cults are caricatured on the edifice of the theory that Ananda per-se is indistinguishable fundamental and the instrumental cause of the universal phenomenon.

From the standpoint of creation Sruti says

आनन्दाद्भयैव खलु इमानि भूतानि जायन्ते

Verily from bliss do all these beings spring forth

This explains the Ananda as imbibed in the Sat or 'Existence' aspect of the Absolute.

From the view point of conscious the Upanishad goes on to say that

आनन्देन जातानि जीवन्ति

All beings are sustained by Ananda or bliss. Thus the principle of Ananda or bliss is interlaced in sentience and consciousness

Dissolution as such is depicted as the "ultimate" into which all created and sustained beings dissolve

Ananda is the remainder. Hence the synonymity of Ananda and Ananta

(To be continued)



Pratyabhijna made easy 17th and 18th Aphorism

Sutra: Madhya vikasat Chidanand labhah

Translation: By expanding the middle (passage) an aspirant attains the bliss of consciousness.

Exposition:

Goddess Samvit is herself what has been referred to as Madhya or The middle . This is because without seeking resort to her as the substratum no one can attain his essential nature since she i.e. Bhagawati manifests as the innermost .

Despite her innermost disposition, in the state of Maya the goddess veils her essential nature and manifests as grosser prana shakti etc and further pervades intellect and body etc . In the process she pursues the passage of thousands of nadis. According to the tantric and yogic canons there are 72000 nadis which converge into 72 and then into 14 and finally into 3 nadis . This arrangement is analogous to the skeleton of a palash leaf that has a main vein which trifurcates then further diverges into myriad veins which pervade the whole leaf .

In the same manner the main central nadi extends up to the orifice of Brahma beginning from the lower mouth or muladhara (Some maintain this as extent from the heart plexus or naval plexus up to the crown of the head or brahmrandhra) .This nadi also termed as Susumna is the seat of pranashakti which in turn is a manifestation of Brahma .

From this main nadi all thought constructs originate and into this they subside .Not withstanding this nadi remains dormant in a pashu or unrefined bound soul.Through the practices mentioned above and to be mentioned later ,when the madhyaniadi Blooms as the innermost power of consciousness -she bestows the bliss of consciousness to the aspirant From that chidanand follows jivanmukti which has been defined already in the 16th sutra .

The next aphorism teaches us a few upayas or knacks for the blooming of the middle or madhyavikasa .

Questions:

1. Madhya refers to Samvit
1. Metaphorically
2. Because she is in the center

3. Since she is the innermost

2. Vikasa in this context is

1. Expansion
2. Development
3. Blooming
4. Entry

3. Nadis are the passages for the circulation of Prana which is

1. Energy we get from food
2. The oxygen we breath in
3. Goddess Samvit who gets gross in her divergent manifestations
4. None of the above

4. How many nadis are there

1. 72,000
2. 72
3. 3
4. All of these

Sutra:Vikalpakshaya, Shakti samkocavikasa, Vahachedda, Aadiantakotinibhahnadayaiahoupaya

Translation:Methods of MadhyaVikasa are given in this aphorism . Cessation of ideation, ,contraction and expansion of Shakti ,cutting the chain of pranic current ,focusing on the beginning and end of awareness and many more knacks from various tantras are the means to it.

Exposition:

Although the expansion of Samvit being referred to as Madhya has been already mentioned as accomplished by the knowledge of ones doer-ship of the five function (refer to the 12th Sutra) a few other methods are also being suggested.In the commentary on the. first sutra VishwaSiddhi is defined as 'sukhopaya', easy to accomplish . This means one doesn't have to undergo the treacherous and tedious procedure of breath control,-pranayama, mudra-mental or physical attitude and mindsets displayed by gestures of hands, eyes or tongue,bandh - contraction of anus, belly, fixing the chin in the hollow of chest , fixing the gaze between the eyebrows so on and so forth .Mudra and bandh taken together mean the means for fixing or binding the

mind .

1. VikalpKshaya:

All an aspirant has to do is to pacify the imagery or ideation which blocks the identification with one's essential nature through the cessation of all thought constructs .As the aspirant has an intuitive insight into his pure subjectively conscious nature bereft of all conditioned experiences of the body etc ,through thought dispersal ,he is able to attain the states of superconsciousness turya and even beyond it i.e. turyatita . Owing to the spontaneous blooming of samvit this takes no time or is accomplished in an instant.

It has been said in the IshwaraPratyabhijna, “By discarding ideation or imagery one attains one pointedness and this in turn leads to the abode of Ishwara”

Spandkarika says

“Whenever the kshobha (mental turmoil) ceases the ultimate is attained”

Jnanagarbha Tantra also states,

“O mother! When having abandoned all activities physical or mental, which a man adopts in order to attain emancipation but on the other hand only leads to further dependence and bondage of the trail of actions, then only by your benevolence aspirants achieve the state of supreme bliss within no time in which there is no sloth and the elixir of homogeneity of bliss prevails”

Only the first upaya i.e. Vikalpaksaya being the foremost is propounded in the Ishwar Pratibhijna. Although the rest are not mentioned in the Pratyabhijna ,these are just to suit the temperament and competence of various aspirants . An aspirant may have inlet into the realm of intuitive insight of the essential nature by choosing the most suitable upaya to him , but the best approach is to learn them from a competent preceptor once the essential nature has been realized. One can try any other or all other upayas . Therefore even though upayas like Shakti samkochvikasaetc are not in the pratyabhijna owing to the tradition and lineage these have been included in this aphorism the last portion ie. etc. refers to many other upayas in VijnanBhairav,Swacchanda

Tantra, SpandKarikas and other Tantras.

2. Shakti samkoch vikas

Shakti samkoch means retrieving of the sense perception which dissipates through the senses .This has been mentioned in the Kathopanisd, “God the creator made the senses divergent by their very nature so they perceive exterior objects and not the indweller atman. Some rare aspirant closed his senses withdrew his awareness inwards to achieve immortality” .

There is an analogy of contraction of a turtles limbs to explain samkoch and vikasa . At other times a turtle withdraws all his limbs and looks like a ball . But when very much scared he withdraws all his senses into heart and looks like a dead lump.After the state of superconsciousness has dawned repeated withdrawals are rendered useless since one is permanently seated in his essential nature .

The vikasa of shakti who is actually innately seated is due to the divergence of the configuration of all senses (Karan chakra).This needs no sequential order .Explaining this as shambhava state the Tantra says , “When the mind is focused inwards but senses are divergent there is no opening or closing of the eyes”.This is a great arcane trance of shambhava kept very secret in the mystic canons .This trance of Bhairava is one in which one is withdrawn even though the senses are divergent .

The Kakshya hymn says:

“O lord you alone appear as the substratum of this universal phenomena as the Senses and their perceptions blend into one instantaneously .And This blend appears as a shaft of golden light.”

This has also been told by Kallat

“By meditating on the manifestation of awareness as vision,touch ,taste,sound,or smell a yogi can attain their respective accomplishments (Sidhi)”

Thus the samkoch and vikasa of Shakti has been expositioned .

Samkoch or contraction by the dilation of the nostrils as the subtle prana energy rises up and pierces the region between the eyebrows -the Urdhava state kundalini assumes the state of resting or termination

of divergence.

Vikasa or Expansion

The lower kundalini (that is when moving downwards) with six faces. To become six fold (ie. divergence in the form of five perceptions and the mind)

Focusing the mind between vis and vahni (the two regions in the sacred plexus) directly or united with vayu the practioner experiences the bliss of coitus. In this verse the term vahni or fire pertains to samkoch or contraction by convergence whereas vis or filament aims at vikasa or divergence.

3. VahaChedda:

Vaha literally means the current and Chhedda cutting asunder .Current in this context refers to the flow of Prana and Apana which is observed in the right and left nostrils respectively . Chedda as explained in the commentary is while the awareness is seated in the heart (plexus) .The aspirant should practice word transcendence alphabetically i.e. by pronouncing अनक्क (the eternal word that contains no vowels or consonants .) This is by focusing on just क् and ह्. That is dispersing all thoughts since in a sophisticated mind all thoughts are distinct and defined in terms of Sanskrit vowels and consonants . The cessation of Pranic current must be accompanied by the tactic of alphabetic thought dispersal . Thus the prana is seated into the cardiac center and this leads to the blooming of Madhya and in turn the attainment of Chidanand .

Jnangarbha explains this phenomena as

“O lord that special bud of wisdom blooms in the heart from which all darkness has been dispelled which suffices to generate paramshiva hood even in a pashu . This bud of wisdom dawns when the aspirant disperses all thoughts except क् bereft of all union with vowels and withdraws the flow of prana and Apana from both nostrils into the consciousness abiding in the heart lotus .”

To sum up

Withdraw the flow of of Prana and Apana in the right and left nostrils .as you do this disperse all alphabet except क् without any vowel . Settle the

pranic current in the “heart” (the place where there is maximum concentration of subjective conscious)

This third upaya also leads to the blooming of the middle nadi .In yogic texts there are two subtler nadis within Susumna namely, Vajrini and Chitrini. Within Chitrini there lies the Kundalini .She is consolidate consciousness so presumably in mystic canons she has been referred to as the middle or madhya and also S amvit

4.AadantaKotiNibhalNadaya

By means of exercise and practice when the mind is fixed at the time of rising of Prana and its coming to an end, on the heart (hrdaya) and the measure of twelve fingers (dvadasanta) respectively awareness can be achieved.

It is said in the 49th verse of VijnanaBhairava , “He whose senses are merged in the ether of the heart, who has entered mentally into the centre of the heart-lotus, who excludes every thing else from consciousness (i.e. who is one-pointed), attains to supreme happiness, O Beautiful One”

Also it is mentioned in the 51st verse of VijnanaBhairava that if one turns one’s mind to dvadasanta all the fluctuations in his mind will diminish every moment and in a few days he will acquire an extra-ordinary status.

This upaya focuses on beginning and end of various experiences and conditions like tasting of pleasant food, aesthetic relish and other sensual pleasures where one manages to meditate on the Self full of bliss as the methods for development of Madhya.

From this development of Madhya is obtained the chidanand, the bliss of consciousness which leads a yogin to samavesa. The attainment of the permanent Samadhi or the permanent state of bliss is explained in the next sutra. The Samadhi a great yogi achieves by using the means given in this sutra has to be strived at through efforts, absorption and assimilation. So there is an arising from this trance. The 19th sutra tells us how to have the spontaneously permanent state of samadhi from which there is no arising.

Questions:

1. Nibhalanam means

- A Concentration
B Focusing
C Pursuing by fixing the “heart” or chittam at the points of beginning and end i.e Adi and Anta
2. Adi etc. refers to other upayas. What do these aim at
A Attainment of spiritual strength
B Madhyavikasa
C Superconsciousness
D All of these
3. Though dispersal is the means per se
A Yes
B No, it just generates one pointedness which in turn leads to Madhyavikasa
C Can't say
4. There are many tactics (upayas) given in the tantra but not in Pratyabhijna. The objective is
A To have many things to choose from
B To befit the requirements of aspirants according to their competence
C To try them one by one in order to reach the same point
5. The term contraction means
A Withdrawl of senses from their objects
B Withdrawl of senses into their source ie. Consciousness or Mind
C Both A & B
D None of these
6. Vikasa or expansion pertains to
A Extrovert state of the senses
B Extrovert divergence of the mind
C Extrovert divergence of Shakti after it has settled in her essential nature as the expansion of the ‘chakra’ of sense organs (Karan chakra) without following a specific order
D Expansion of the karan chakra following the order of expansion, withdrawl, absorption etc.
7. Unmesa is
A Unfolding
B Opening of the eye
C The span of thoughtlessness between the consequent ideas- to be experienced subjectively
D None of these
8. In the upaya ‘Vaha Chedda’ chedda is done by

- converging the awareness in the heart and
A Holding the breath
B Stopping breathing
C By pronouncing the letter ‘k’ mentally without vowels
D By contracting the vocal apparatus

9. Explain the process of Samkoch and Vikasa as the ascent and descent of upper and lower Kundalini – after the ‘eye brow center’ is pierced by exercising the power of Prana (In 10 sentences)



A brief insight in the online classes conducted by YTA

In the Yogtantragama Study Circle we read and discuss many arcance texts in the divine guidance of our Guru Maharaj Swami Paranand Tirth ji. Swamiji reads and explains the metaphysical import of these texts along with conventional commentaries.

Currently we are studying Mrgendra Agama, Nareshwar Pariksha and Shri Vidya Ratnakar in the divine guidance of our Guru Maharaj, Swami Paranand Tirth ji . The former two texts are dualistic Saiva texts while the latter is a manual of Srividya worship compiled by Swami Karpatri Maharaj. Swamiji explains the cryptic sutras and expositions in a manner that we can grasp it better.

In last few months we have completed the study of ‘Durgasaptashati’, ‘Tara Bhakti Sudarnav’ and ‘Shiva Sutra’. Though the classes are in sanskrit with a little patience and self study one can immensely benefit from them. Anyone interested to join us may please request Swamiji for the link.



Carnelian Tears

~ Ambika Talwar



Effulgent with lament
tender hot fire
rages like shimmer
on river of
tears on every petal
hidden while heart
peers from enclosed
buds –
what if this were a garland
to wear in my hair
who would gaze
at my composure
I submit I am
coming undone
nothing can hold me together
again...
for this unutterable beauty
I am happy to become
river of carnelian tears
gather me in a crystal
goblet - will you?
before moon burns up
and my veins lose
their dignity

#

(c) 18 March 2020

To Birth a New Life

~ Ambika Talwar



Such beauty as you reveal
bursts as new life
on an old trodden path
sparks of red –
how time binds beginnings
with all that is gone
blood in the valley
of Shiva where Parvati
sheds her skins – her clothing
caught become buds,

as many songs eternal
become caught in our throat.

How our hands become
stamens corolla crown –
how shall we wear
these flowers on our heads
garlands round our neck
our wrists when our pens
bleed with love? – Love's
veritable longings sink into soil,
melt under snowy passages.

What new way shall we birth?
Even She wanders in search.

Beauty of search is tender,
for feet may break on
fallen pebbles skittering
under bluest of skies where
Kashmir is a paradise
caught in our throats...

Even thorns bleed where life
is quartered with falsehood.
Lift old songs from dust to free us
of Time's curses – melodies to
harmonize wintry valleys

of Shiva hungering for Sati –
as delicate saffron petals
reveal new life bursting free!

Know well our heart's desires
before hell breaks loose...
Be the koyel for all seasons!

(Ambika Talwar is an India-born author, poet, wellness consultant, artist, and educator whose vision is to realize her sacred destiny and invite others to brilliance. She has authored *4 Stars and 25 Roses* (poems for her father) and *My Greece: Mirrors & Metamorphoses* about her travels through Greece in 2002.)





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